

SIGNALLING

Signalling, aided by telecommunication, is a large part of the railways' safety mechanism. As the number of trains operating in the Indian Railways' circuit has grown, so has the signalling system, which has evolved over the decades. Without it, the entire rail network would be in disarray.



▲ **A combination of semaphore signals** in operation on the Western Railway.

The initial signalling system in India was rudimentary, gradually evolving as single lines became double, the traffic increased, and the network became complex. During the 19th and 20th centuries, these changes borrowed heavily from the improvements in the Western